

The Tolan Tale

DANDY DON MEREDITH says there are 10 foreign-born field goal kickers in the NFL. Asked how to defense Garo Yepremian and the other soccer-style foreign-born kickers, Norm Van Brocklin of the Atlanta Falcons said, "tighten the immigration laws." Bobby Tolan played for the Tulsa Oilers in 1964. They were in the Texas League then and we saw them play against the Sun Kings at Dudley Field. Tolan was a speedster who hit .297 for Tulsa. He looked like a "couldn't miss" big league prospect. The Pirates evidently didn't think he was or they would not have let him get away to the St. Louis Cardinals by the draft. The Cards traded him to Cincinnati for Vada Pinson and with the Reds, he hit .305 in 1970 and .303 in 1971, led the National League in stolen bases in 1970 with 57. He sat out the 1972 season with a leg injury. This year he slumped to .206 and had some clubhouse hassles that led to his suspension. He'll miss the playoffs, and the World Series even if the Reds make it. They'll probably trade him during the winter. I'm sorry to hear that Boomer Nunez, one of El Paso's most colorful sports figures, was decked with a heart attack. I'm glad to hear that he's improving. Andy Cohen tells about the baseball game his Miners played against the New Mexico State Aggies. No umpires showed up. Presley Askew, the Ag coach, agreed to umpire. He called balls and strikes and plays and coached the Aggie team, too. The Miners won 2-1.